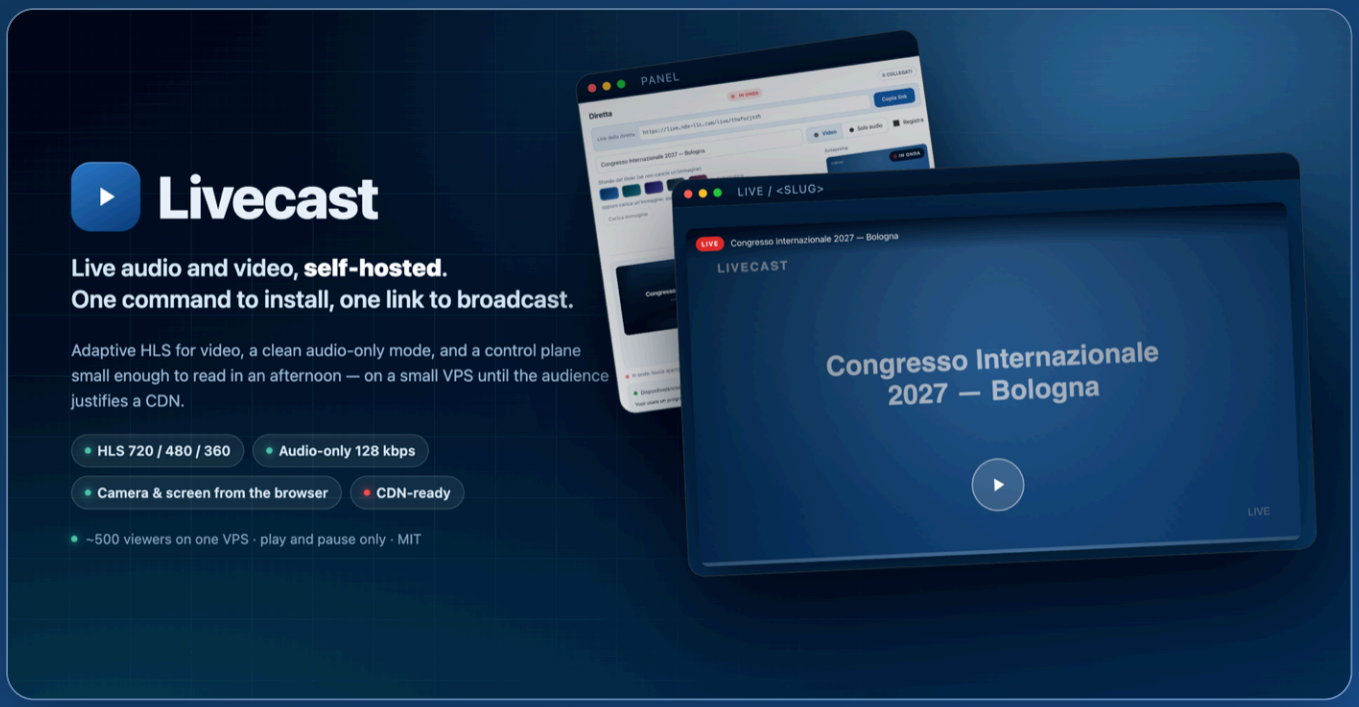


Livecast

How to set up a broadcast, simply.

The flow, simplified:

📹 external encoder optional → 🖥️ Livecast VPS turns it into streams → 📱 Public link play / pause →

👥 Viewers → ☁️ CDN beyond ~500 viewers

The software is free (MIT) and rebrandable: name, colours and images are changed from the panel, no code edits needed.

Quick guide · version 1.0 · https://github.com/sdagostino777/livecast

1. What you need

1. **an external streaming program** on a computer (Windows, macOS, Linux) — the program that sends the video. Free ones exist for all three; this guide does not require any specific one.
2. **A VPS** running Ubuntu (4 GB of RAM is plenty for one broadcast) and a **domain** with a DNS `A` record pointing at the VPS.
3. The Livecast repository, and five minutes for the initial install.

1. Download it (once)

On GitHub: green **Code → Download ZIP** (fine from a phone too — upload the ZIP to the server). From a terminal:

```
curl -L https://github.com/sdagostino777/livecast/archive/refs/heads/main.tar.gz -o livecast.tgz
```

```
tar xzf livecast.tgz && cd livecast-main
```

2. One command installs everything

In your server's terminal (Hostinger → VPS → **Terminal**, as root), inside the folder you just unpacked, type:

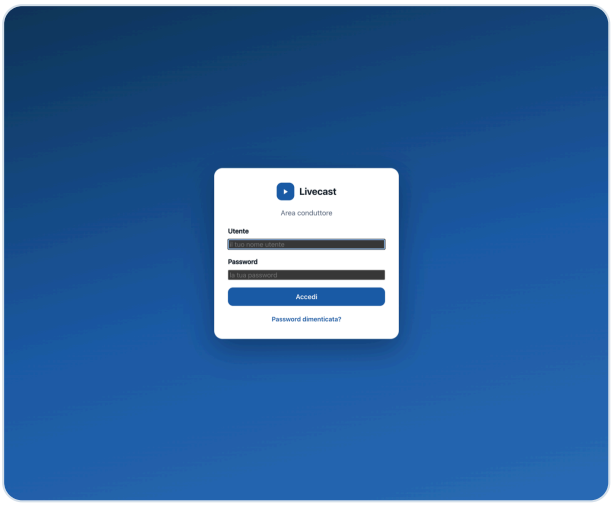
```
bash install.sh live.yourdomain.com
```

It installs the media server, the encoder, the services that restart themselves after a failure, free HTTPS, the firewall and the **admin** account. Nothing else: an external encoder is not mandatory and no file needs editing by hand.

3. First login: open `https://live.yourdomain.com/admin`, user **admin**, password **admin**. The panel **forces you to change it immediately**: pick at least 12 characters and you are in.

2. First login and creating a broadcast

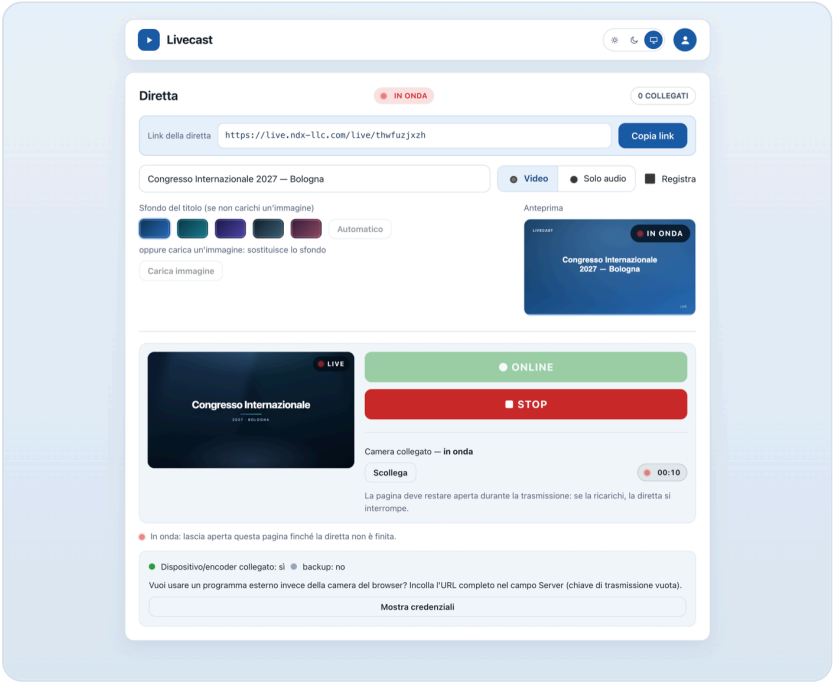
Open the panel link and sign in. Top right you will find three small icons for the **theme** (light, dark, system) and the **account** button (the person icon), which opens **Impostazioni** (settings) and **Esci** (sign out).



1. Sign-in screen.

In the **Diretta** box write the title — for example **Congresso Internazionale 2027 — Bologna** — choose **Video** or **Audio only**, add the **event image** if you want (and tick "Show the event name over the image" to print the title on it). There is nothing to save: every change applies at once and the preview follows while you type. When you are ready press ● **ONLINE**.

The broadcast link sits right above, with **Copia link**: you can already share it, because whoever opens it sees the event name and image even before you go live. After the show, **Nuovo evento** creates the next event with a **new link**.



2. The panel while on air: state, link, preview and the camera feed.

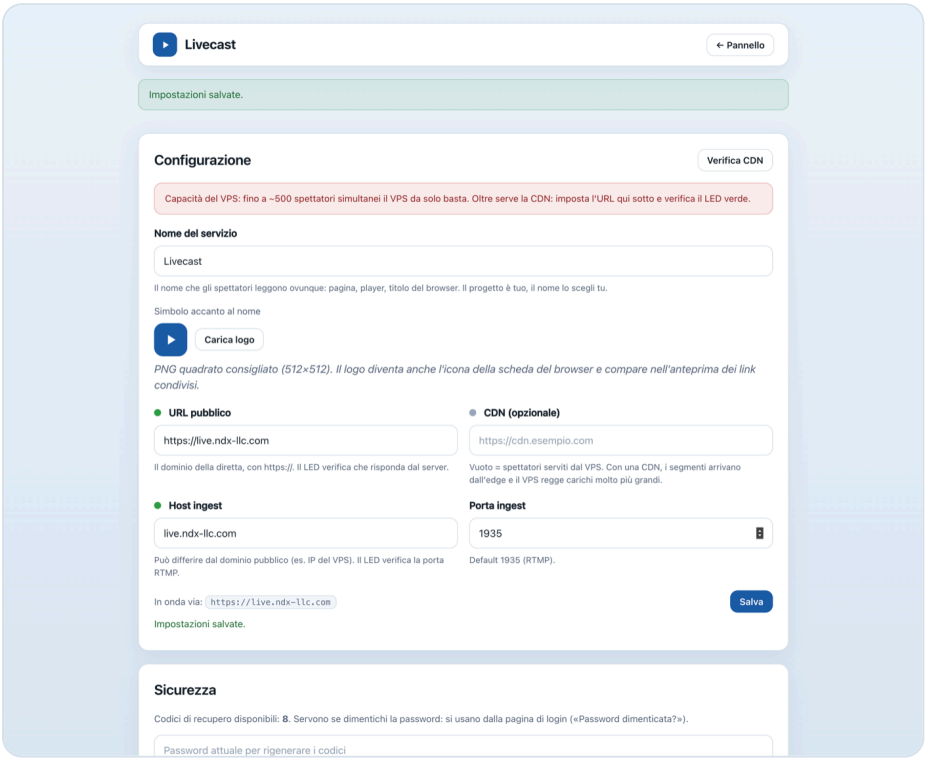
No image at hand? The system **generates one** from the event title on a gradient background (deep navy, petrol, indigo…). Replace it whenever you like with "Carica immagine".

3. Settings (from the account menu)

Pick **Impostazioni** from the account button. The page collects what belongs to the service, not to the event:

- **Configurazione**: the **service name** and **logo** — yours, and shown to whoever receives the link; the logo also becomes the browser tab icon. Below: **public URL**, the **CDN** if you use one, and the **ingest host/port**, with **Verifica CDN** and **Salva**.
- **Sicurezza**: your password and the recovery codes.
- **Utenti** (admin only): who else may broadcast.
- **Manutenzione**: closes broadcasts left hanging and shows the **logs**.

The **theme** is not here: the three small icons top right switch it instantly. The event image and the “Show the event name over the image” checkbox live in the **Diretta** box, next to the title.



3. Settings: name, logo, public URL, CDN and ingest; then security, users, maintenance.

4. Going live

Two ways, no mandatory software. In the panel, under the broadcast, you find **Collega camera** and **Collega schermo** preview and connect the browser to the server — **nobody sees you** until you press ● **ONLINE**. The page must stay open during the broadcast — reloading it stops the transmission. For long events an external encoder is the safer choice (it reconnects by itself): here is how to configure it.

In the panel press **Mostra credenziali** (show credentials) and copy the full server URL. In the encoder → **Settings → Stream**:

external encoder — Settings → Stream

Service	Custom…
Server	rtmp://live.yourdomain.com:1935/live?user=publisher&pass=••••••
Stream key	*(empty)*

Press **Start streaming** in the encoder: the panel turns to **In onda** within seconds and the **time on air** counter starts. Next to the state you can read how many people are **connected** right now. Copy the link and share it: WhatsApp already shows a preview with the event name and image. Viewers see the poster and a play button — play and pause, nothing more.



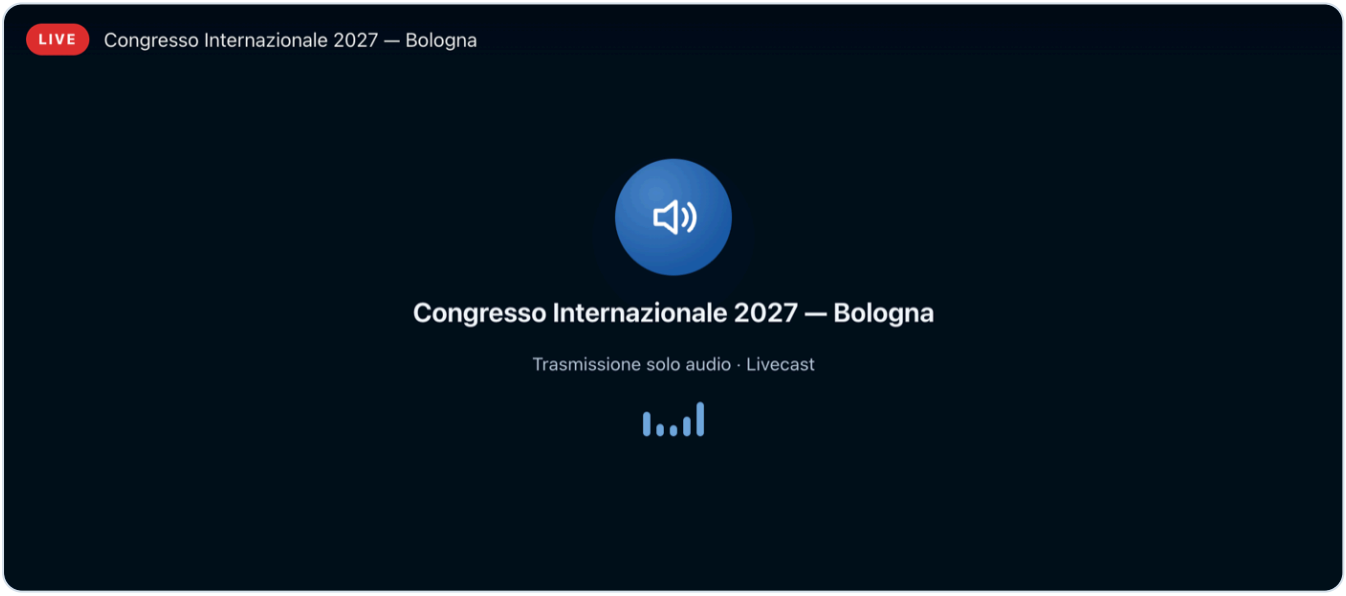
4. Before play: the event name and image, then just play.

5. What the viewer sees

During the broadcast: play and pause, the **LIVE** badge and the title. Nothing else — every extra control is one more thing to get wrong on a phone in a crowd.



5. The player: play and pause only, as it should be.



6. An «Audio only» broadcast: same simplicity, with the audio card.

6. Forgot your password? Recovery codes

When you set (or reset) the password, the system generates **8 recovery codes** and shows them **once**. Copy or print them: they are the only way back in on your own if you forget the password.

```
38247-FA538 · 890E4-A0BB6 · 28537-304BB · AA636-54122
D13F4-A3352 · F8FBC-E02C8 · C8454-86EE7 · EB5DC-70BEF
```

This is what they look like. Yours will differ: save yours.

1. On the sign-in page press **Password dimenticata?**.
2. Enter the user, **one code** and the new password (at least 12 characters).
3. The password changes and **every session is closed**. Each code works **once**.
4. In **Settings → Sicurezza** you can see how many codes remain and **regenerate** them (current password required: the old ones stop working).

Lost the codes too? Whoever administers the server resets the password from the command line. The command also prints 8 new codes:

```
cd /srv/livecast/app
```

```
node --env-file=.env apps/api/dist/cli.js reset-password --username admin --
password admin
```

In the database the codes are stored only as a **cryptographic hash**: nobody — not even the server administrator — can read the plaintext code back.

7. Viewers, CDN and the unexpected

How many viewers does the VPS handle? Up to **~500 simultaneous** the VPS alone is enough. Beyond that you need a CDN: in the panel → **Configurazione** enter the CDN URL and check that the LED next to it ● turns **green**. With a CDN viewers load video from the edge and the VPS stays light.

5. On air: the blinking dot and the STOP button stay visible.

When things break

1. **the encoder disconnects** → the pipeline restarts by itself within seconds; when the encoder reconnects the video returns.
2. **The primary encoder dies** → if a second encoder is connected to the backup URL, the panel shows “In uso: backup” and the broadcast continues.
3. **The server dies** → no software on that server can save it: you need a standby VPS with the data (the `DATA_DIR` folder) and DNS re-pointed. That is the emergency plan to prepare for important events.

Where to find the rest

README · **docs/RUNBOOK.md** (operations, CDN, recovery) · **docs/CDN.md** (Bunny CDN step by step) · **docs/guides/guide-it.pdf** (this guide in Italian).